1/Mar/2026
Sunday

Feb, Spaceship you.

* Mobile phone position
* The dispossessed by Ursula.K.Le.Guin
* Turtles all the way down by John Green
* Advent of Code 10_b, 11_a & 11_b

I used to keep my mobile phone near me always. This includes – bed, work, washroom, library. This has been my default ever since I got my phone – in college.

I remember watching a CGP Grey video about separating out things in life. One of the main ideas of the video is to not use your smart phone in bed or in the place where you work. I respected the ideas from the video, but I never implemented them to my life. I have a screen timer app that prevents me from using social media apps more than 5 min at a time. So I assumed that this mental health improvement for separating things in life would never be applicable to me.

This month I decided to humor Grey's video. I started keeping my phone outside my work + sleep room.

The change in my mental health is stark. I am more happy. I checked my screen time – to give some objective results. But my screen time did not change. I still look in the same amount of time. I checked the number of unlocks per day. There is a 50% drop in unlock count.

My hypothesis is that when I keep my phone near my work station, I keep on taking micro ~~decis~~ decisions to constantly check my whatsapp / instagram. This adds a ~~ad~~ cognitive load which in turn leads to sadness.

I would strongly recomend everyone to try separating your body from smartphone while doing focused work.

Reading:

Le Guin:

Me and Darshan had a lots of discussion on the contents of this book. The book talks about a revolution that lead to the formation of ~~an anarchic society~~ an anarchical society. Le Guin does not shy away from exploring the dissadvantages of such a society. This approach of Le Guin was a great highlight for me while reading.

John Green's Turtles all the way down

The protagonist of the book was super relatable for me. I personally go through some amounts of overthinking. Reading about Aza (the protagonist) helped me, in some ways, to cope with my overthiking.

Much of my current overthinking revolves around job security, financial freedom/independence, life satisfaction, and the uncertainity of getting accepted back into academia.

Advent of Code:

I ended up solving 10b finally. 11a&b ~~we~~ were a breeze compared to 11. I used Linear Programming solvers to solve 10b. It feels like cheating - but YOLO.

I have also decided to abandon Rust language for any competitive programming type work. Finding & designing the algorithm is difficult enough. I don't want to add the additional complexity that Rust syntax & memory safety adds. I might retry using Rust for a backend project in the future.